SSC CHSL 2020 Tier-I question paper with answers

6 August 2021 · Shift 3

67 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 33 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20211105175401/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2020_05112021.pdf

English Language 25 questions

Q.1

Select the misspelt word.

(A) already
(B) library
(C) instalment
(D) boundry

Q.2

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. My brother lost / his job during the lockdown, / but he had got / a new job now.

(A) his job during the lockdown
(B) but he had got
(C) a new job now
(D) My brother lost

Q.3

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. A school teacher earns “fewer salary from” a college lecturer.

(A) a lower salary than
(B) No substitution required
(C) fewer salary than
(D) less salary from

Q.4

Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Select the option that gives their correct order. A. Once, on an airplane, I leaned over to tie my shoelace. B. I found myself pinned helplessly in the crash position, unable to move. C. I always have catastrophes when I travel. D. Just at that moment, the person in the seat ahead threw his seat back into full recline.

(A) ABDC
(B) CADB
(C) DBAC
(D) BDAC

Q.5

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A strong interest in something or someone

(A) Fixation
(B) Empathy
(C) Apathy
(D) Attachment

Q.6

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech. She told the car mechanic that her car was giving very low mileage.

(A) The car mechanic said to her, “Your car is giving very low mileage.”

(B) She said to the car mechanic, “Her car has been giving very low mileage.”

(C) She said to the car mechanic, “My car is giving very low mileage.”

(D) She asked the car mechanic, “Why is my car giving very low mileage?”

Q.7

Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word. SAVAGE

(A) violent

(B) cultured

(C) vicious

(D) brutal

Q.8

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select ‘No substitution’. The workers’ union has threatened “for going to” an indefinite strike.

(A) to be going for

(B) No substitution

(C) for going to

(D) to go on

Q.9

Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given words. To come to an end

(A) initiate

(B) exhale

(C) inspire

(D) expire

Q.10

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. COMMENCE

(A) complete

(B) resume

(C) conclude

(D) launch

Q.11

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Friendly

(A) Amiable

(B) Zealous

(C) Hostile

(D) Upright

Q.12

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. Organic food seems to be “in vogue” these days.

(A) readily available

(B) out of stock

(C) in fashion

(D) very expensive

Q.13

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the right order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A. Oprah Winfrey is one of the richest and most powerful American women, loved and admired by everyone. B. When she was only 19, she became the first black female assistant to Nashville’s evening news anchor. C. But Oprah had a very difficult and traumatic childhood. D. In 1986, Oprah became the television presenter of her own talk show called ‘The Oprah Winfrey Show’.

(A) CBDA

(B) DACB

(C) ABDC

(D) BCAD

Q.14

Fill in the blank with most appropriate word. I am _____ of joining the armed forces.

(A) interested
(B) keen
(C) desirous
(D) eager

Q.15

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Benifitiary
(B) Territory
(C) Strategy
(D) Tractor

Q.16

In the given sentence, identify the segment which contains a grammatical error. Every participant gave so outstanding performance that it became difficult to choose the winner.

(A) Every participant gave
(B) so outstanding performance
(C) to choose the winner
(D) that it became difficult

Q.17

Select the correct passive form of the given sentence. She has put fresh flowers in the flower vase.

(A) Fresh flowers are put in the flower vase.
(B) Fresh flowers are being put in the flower vase.
(C) Fresh flowers has been put in the flower vase.
(D) Fresh flowers have been put in the flower vase.

Q.18

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. To play with fire

(A) To act in a dangerous and risky way
(B) To hold a revenge against someone
(C) To fight fires like a fireman
(D) To pour oil on a burning fire

Q.19

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Imitate

(A) Mimic
(B) Effect
(C) Disregard
(D) Enlighten

Q.20

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. You don't usually discuss money with friends, because it may _____ the relationship negatively.

(A) affect
(B) improve
(C) strengthen
(D) effect

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. The little princess said, "I shut you in a golden cage because I wanted to have you all to (1) _____. I never knew it would make you so unhappy. I love you (2) _____ to grant you freedom and let you be happy in your (3) _____." Then she opened the cage and let out the (4) _____ little bird. The bird said, "I will come back to sing you the (5) _____ songs I know," and flew away into the blue.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 1.

(A) himself
(B) herself
(C) myself
(D) itself

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. The little princess said, “I shut you in a golden cage because I wanted to have you all to (1) _____. I never knew it would make you so unhappy. I love you (2) _____ to grant you freedom and let you be happy in your (3) _____.” Then she opened the cage and let out the (4) _____ little bird. The bird said, “I will come back to sing you the (5) _____ songs I know,” and flew away into the blue.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 2.

(A) so much
(B) enough
(C) more
(D) so

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. The little princess said, “I shut you in a golden cage because I wanted to have you all to (1) _____. I never knew it would make you so unhappy. I love you (2) _____ to grant you freedom and let you be happy in your (3) _____.” Then she opened the cage and let out the (4) _____ little bird. The bird said, “I will come back to sing you the (5) _____ songs I know,” and flew away into the blue.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 3.

(A) way
(B) turn
(C) cage
(D) path

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. The little princess said, “I shut you in a golden cage because I wanted to have you all to (1) _____. I never knew it would make you so unhappy. I love you (2) _____ to grant you freedom and let you be happy in your (3) _____.” Then she opened the cage and let out the (4) _____ little bird. The bird said, “I will come back to sing you the (5) _____ songs I know,” and flew away into the blue.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 4.

(A) terrorizing
(B) terrifying
(C) terrified
(D) terrible

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. The little princess said, “I shut you in a golden cage because I wanted to have you all to (1) _____. I never knew it would make you so unhappy. I love you (2) _____ to grant you freedom and let you be happy in your (3) _____.” Then she opened the cage and let out the (4) _____ little bird. The bird said, “I will come back to sing you the (5) _____ songs I know,” and flew away into the blue.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 5.

(A) much lovely
(B) more lovely
(C) most lovelier
(D) loveliest

General Intelligence 18 questions

Q.2

Two statements are given, followed by three conclusions numbered I, II and III. Assuming the statements to be true, even if they seem to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All bottles are utensils. All kitchens are utensils. Conclusions: I. No bottle is a kitchen. II. Some bottles are kitchens. III. No utensil is a bottle.

(A) Either conclusion I or II follows
(B) Only conclusions I and II follow
(C) All the conclusions follow
(D) Only conclusions II and III follow

Q.3

Mahendra is the son of Naman, who is the brother of Reema's mother. How is Mahendra related to Reema?

(A) Cousin
(B) Son
(C) Uncle
(D) Brother

Q.4

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. (15, 7, 252)

(A) (12, 16, 372)
(B) (23, 9, 510)
(C) (27, 10, 520)
(D) (16, 14, 451)

Q.5

Three of the following four words are alike in a certain way and one is different. Select the odd one.

(A) Dry Fruits
(B) Almond
(C) Cashew
(D) Walnuts

Q.6

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. FOR : MVY : : DEX : ?

(A) KLE
(B) LLF
(C) KME
(D) KLF

Q.7

Select the combination of letters that when sequentially placed in the blanks of the given letter series will complete the series. p _ q q r _ p p q _ r r _ p q _ _ r

(A) p r q p q r
(B) r p q r p q
(C) q q p p r r
(D) q p r q r q

Q.8

Select the option in which the words share the same relationship as that shared by the given pair of words. Axe : Chop

(A) Scalpel : Stitching
(B) Chisel : Carve
(C) Scissor : Design
(D) Compass : Architecture

Q.9

Four letter-clusters have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the letter-cluster that is different.

(A) XZCG
(B) BDGK
(C) VYAE
(D) MORV

Q.10

In a code language, MAGIC is written as NZTRX. How will LAYER be written in that language?

(A) OZBVH
(B) NZBVQ
(C) OZBVI
(D) PZPVI

Q.11

In a certain code language, 'FOSTER' is coded as '61219202218' and 'CARGO' is coded as '32618712'. How will 'MARRIAGE' be coded in that language?

(A) 132618180926705
(B) 132618181826722
(C) 140118181801722
(D) 132609091826705

Q.13

Four number-pairs have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the number-pair that is different.

(A) 4 : 70
(B) 7 : 349
(C) 3 : 30
(D) 8 : 518

Q.15

Ankit is 30 years younger than his father. After 4 years Ankit's sister will be half the age of her father. The total of the present ages of Ankit and his sister is 67 years. What is the present age of Ankit's father?

(A) 66 years
(B) 48 years
(C) 60 years
(D) 52 years

Q.16

Select the correct option that indicates the arrangement of the given words in the order in which they appear in an English dictionary. 1. Mosaic 2. Mosquito 3. Mortgage 4. Moratorium 5. Morphed

(A) 4, 5, 3, 1, 2
(B) 1, 4, 3, 2, 5
(C) 4, 3, 1, 2, 5
(D) 4, 1, 3, 5, 2

Q.17

Select the option that is related to the fourth number in the same way as the first number is related to the second number and the fifth number is related to the sixth number. 26 : 182 : : ? : 203 : : 38 : 266

(A) 35
(B) 29
(C) 33
(D) 27

Q.18

Which two signs and two numbers should be interchanged to make the given equation correct? 12 × 5 + 7 ÷ 4 – 6 = 25

(A) × and ÷, 7 and 6
(B) × and –, 6 and 5
(C) ÷ and –, 4 and 12
(D) × and +, 12 and 4

Q.21

Select the option in which the numbers share the same relationship as that shared by the numbers in the given set. (6, 8, 192)

(A) (11, 9, 396)
(B) (7, 5, 78)
(C) (12, 13, 263)
(D) (8, 11, 180)

Q.23

Select the number that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 14, 29, 60, 123, ? , 505

(A) 305
(B) 250
(C) 280
(D) 150

Q.24

'Soldier' is related to 'Security' in the same way as 'Farmer' is related to '_____'.

(A) Army
(B) Agriculture
(C) Poverty
(D) Rain

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1

Who among the following represented India at the international level in shooting?

(A) Aditi Chauhan
(B) Anjum Moudgil
(C) Amit Panghal
(D) Ashalata Devi

Q.2

Ujjain is on the banks of river _____.

(A) Kshipra
(B) Dibang
(C) Sarayu
(D) Saraswati

Q.3

Which of the following is NOT a correct match of Dargah and its respective location?

(A) Shaikh Nizamuddin Auliya Dargah - Agra
(B) Khwaja Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki Dargah - Delhi
(C) Haji Ali Dargah - Mumbai
(D) Shaikh Muinuddin Sijzi (chishti) Dargah - Ajmer

Q.4

Which of the following was the first operating system written in 'C' language?

(A) UNIX
(B) Windows 95
(C) Xenix
(D) LINUX

Q.5

Which of the following is the correct full form of JPEG?

(A) Joint Pixel Experts Group
(B) Joint Photographic Experts Group
(C) Joint Pixel Exports Group
(D) Joint Photography Exports Group

Q.6

Who among the following was the captain of women's hockey team of India as of December 2020?

(A) Rajani Etimarpu
(B) Rani Rampal
(C) Reena Khokhar
(D) Grace Ekka

Q.7

Who won the Chess.com's 2020 Junior Speed Online Chess Championship after beating Russia's Alexey Sarana?

(A) Magnus Carlsen
(B) D Gukesh
(C) Raunak Sadhwani
(D) Nihal Sarin

Q.8

Which Indian actor received the ‘Crystal Award’ at the World Economic Forum 2020?

(A) Deepika Padukone
(B) Alia Bhatt
(C) Kareena Kapoor
(D) Katrina Kaif

Q.9

Ministry of Finance introduced a new form called Form 26AS for:

(A) school admission application
(B) tax payers
(C) e-Visa application
(D) job application

Q.10

Which of the following national parks is situated in Kerala?

(A) Tadoba National Park
(B) Kaziranga National Park
(C) Sanjay Gandhi National Park
(D) Eravikulam National Park

Q.11

Which of the following statements about blood pressure is correct?

(A) The normal systolic pressure is about 80 mm of Hg and diastolic pressure is 120 mm of Hg.
(B) The normal systolic pressure is about 72 mm of Hg and diastolic pressure is 35 mm of Hg.
(C) The normal systolic pressure is about 160 mm of Hg and diastolic pressure is 80 mm of Hg.
(D) The normal systolic pressure is about 120 mm of Hg and diastolic pressure is 80 mm of Hg.

Q.12

How many recognised essential vitamins are there as on March 2021?

(A) 15
(B) 11
(C) 13
(D) 9

Q.13

For which of the following categories were Paul R Milgrom and Robert B Wilson awarded the Nobel Prize in 2020?

(A) Chemistry
(B) Physiology or Medicine
(C) Literature
(D) Economic Sciences

Q.14

Which of the following states had the highest per capita income for the year 2019-2020?

(A) Gujarat
(B) Goa
(C) Kerala
(D) Sikkim

Q.15

Which country apart from India was declared a winner at the 2020 Online FIDE Chess Olympiad?

(A) Sweden
(B) Russia
(C) Brazil
(D) Finland

Q.16

Good Governance Day is observed annually on 25 December on the birth anniversary of _____.

(A) Atal Bihari Vajpayee
(B) Rajiv Gandhi
(C) Jawaharlal Nehru
(D) P. V. Narasimha Rao

Q.17

IC 1101 is a _____.

(A) asteroid
(B) galaxy
(C) supernova
(D) satellite

Q.18

Which of the following was the first High Court established in India?

(A) Bombay
(B) Calcutta
(C) Delhi
(D) Madras

Q.19

Who among the following is NOT a part of the committee, which is constructed to provide suggestions to the Prime Minister regarding the appointment of a chief commissioner of Central Information Commission?

(A) Speaker of the Lok Sabha
(B) A Union Cabinet Minister appointed by Prime Minister
(C) Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha
(D) Prime Minister

Q.20

Which of the following rivers is a tributary of Krishna River?

(A) Bhavani
(B) Tungabhadra
(C) Hemavati
(D) Amravati

Q.21

To which of the following states does the dance drama ‘Khyal’ belong?

(A) Rajasthan
(B) Gujarat
(C) Madhya Pradesh
(D) Punjab

Q.22

In Indian history who were referred to as the 'atavika rajya'?

(A) South Indian kingdom
(B) Republican state
(C) Forest kingdom
(D) Mughal empire

Q.23

Which of the following ministries launched the e-Sampada mobile app in December 2020?

(A) Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs
(B) Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare
(C) Ministry of Ayurveda, Yoga & Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha and Homoeopathy
(D) Ministry of Home Affairs

Q.25

Which of the following festivals is celebrated for fertility and better fortune in Jharkhand?

(A) Karam
(B) Sarhul
(C) Sohrai
(D) Jawa

Answer key

English Language

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

General Intelligence

Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(A)**	Q.7 **(A)**
Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.13 **(C)**	Q.15 **(A)**
Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(B)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.25 **(D)**

Explanations

English Language

Q.1 · Answer (D) boundry

The correct spelling is 'boundary'. ('Instalment' is the British spelling.)

Q.2 · Answer (B) but he had got

'Now' calls for the present perfect: 'but he has got a new job now', not the past perfect 'had got'.

Q.3 · Answer (A) a lower salary than

'Fewer' goes only with plural nouns ('fewer jobs'), and a comparison takes 'than', not 'from': 'A school teacher earns a lower salary than a college lecturer.'

Q.4 · Answer (B) CADB

C states the theme (catastrophes when travelling), A begins the story, D gives the moment the seat came back and B the result: CADB.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Fixation

A fixation is a very strong, even obsessive, interest in something or someone.

Q.6 · Answer (C) She said to the car mechanic, “My car is giving very low mileage.”

In direct speech 'told' becomes 'said to', the past continuous 'was giving' returns to the present 'is giving', and 'her car' becomes 'my car'.

Q.7 · Answer (B) cultured

'Savage' means wild and uncivilised; its opposite is 'cultured'. 'Violent', 'vicious' and 'brutal' are near synonyms.

Q.8 · Answer (D) to go on

'Threaten' takes a to-infinitive, and a strike is something one goes 'on': 'threatened to go on an indefinite strike'.

Q.9 · Answer (D) expire

To 'expire' is to come to an end, as a licence or a period of time does.

Q.10 · Answer (D) launch

To 'commence' is to begin: to 'launch'. 'Resume' means to begin again after a pause.

Q.11 · Answer (C) Hostile

The opposite of 'friendly' is 'hostile'. 'Amiable' is a synonym.

Q.12 · Answer (C) in fashion

'In vogue' means in fashion, popular at the time.

Q.13 · Answer (C) ABDC

A, which introduces Oprah, opens the paragraph, and ABDC is the only option that begins with it: B and D follow her career in order of date (at 19, then in 1986), and C, starting with 'But', sets her hard childhood against that success.

Q.14 · Answer (C) desirous

'Desirous' takes 'of': 'desirous of joining'. 'Interested' takes 'in', 'keen' takes 'on' and 'eager' takes 'to' or 'for'.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Benifitiary

The correct spelling is 'beneficiary'.

Q.16 · Answer (B) so outstanding performance

An adjective with a singular noun takes 'such a/an', not 'so': 'gave such an outstanding performance that it became difficult'.

Q.17 · Answer (D) Fresh flowers have been put in the flower vase.
The present perfect 'has put' becomes 'have been put', plural to agree with 'fresh flowers'.

Q.18 · Answer (A) To act in a dangerous and risky way
To 'play with fire' is to do something dangerous and risky.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Mimic
To 'imitate' is to copy: to 'mimic'.

Q.20 · Answer (A) affect
'Affect' is the verb meaning to influence; 'effect' as a verb means to bring about. 'Improve' and 'strengthen' do not fit 'negatively'.

Q.21 · Answer (C) myself
The speaker is 'I', so the reflexive is 'myself': 'to have you all to myself'.

Q.22 · Answer (B) enough
'Enough to' gives the degree that makes something possible: 'I love you enough to grant you freedom'.

Q.23 · Answer (A) way
To be happy 'in your way', living as the bird itself chooses.

Q.24 · Answer (C) terrified
'Terrified' (feeling fear) describes the caged bird; 'terrifying' would mean causing fear.

Q.25 · Answer (D) loveliest
'The ... songs I know' calls for a superlative: 'the loveliest songs'. 'Most lovelier' wrongly puts 'most' before the comparative 'lovelier'.

General Intelligence

Q.2 · Answer (A) Either conclusion I or II follows
Bottles and kitchens are both utensils, but nothing links them to each other, so neither I nor II is certain; they are a complementary pair (no bottle is a kitchen / some bottles are kitchens), so one of them must be true. III contradicts the first statement.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Cousin
Naman is the brother of Reema's mother, so he is her maternal uncle; his son Mahendra is Reema's cousin.

Q.4 · Answer (A) (12, 16, 372)
The third number is $a(a-1) + b(b-1)$: $15 \times 14 + 7 \times 6 = 210 + 42 = 252$. Likewise $12 \times 11 + 16 \times 15 = 132 + 240 = 372$.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Dry Fruits
Almond, cashew and walnuts are all dry fruits; 'dry fruits' is the class they belong to.

Q.6 · Answer (A) KLE
Each letter moves 7 places forward: F → M, O → V, R → Y. So D → K, E → L and X → E (wrapping round after Z): KLE.

Q.7 · Answer (A) p r q p q r
With p, r, q, p, q, r in the blanks the block ppqqrr repeats: ppqqrr ppqqrr ppqqrr.

Q.8 · Answer (B) Chisel : Carve
An axe is used to chop, as a chisel is used to carve: a tool and its work.

Q.9 · Answer (C) VYAE
In XZCG, BDGK and MORV the letters move +2, +3, +4 (Z to C wrapping round). VYAE moves +3, +2, +4, so it is the odd one.

Q.10 · Answer (C) OZBVI

Each letter is replaced by its opposite in the alphabet (A ↔ Z, B ↔ Y, ...): M → N, A → Z, G → T, I → R, C → X. So L → O, A → Z, Y → B, E → V, R → I: OZBVI.

Q.11 · Answer (B) 132618181826722

Consonants are written as their place in the alphabet, and vowels as the place of their opposite letter (A → Z = 26, E → V = 22, I → R = 18, O → L = 12): FOSTER = 6 12 19 20 22 18. MARRIAGE = 13 26 18 18 18 26 7 22.

Q.13 · Answer (C) 3 : 30

4 : 70, 7 : 349 and 8 : 518 are each $n : n^3 + 6$ (64 + 6, 343 + 6, 512 + 6). For 3 it would be 27 + 6 = 33, not 30.

Q.15 · Answer (A) 66 years

Let the father be F. Ankit is F − 30, and the sister, half the father's age in 4 years, is (F + 4)/2 − 4 = (F − 4)/2 now. (F − 30) + (F − 4)/2 = 67 gives 3F = 198, so F = 66.

Q.16 · Answer (A) 4, 5, 3, 1, 2

In dictionary order: Moratorium (4), Morphed (5), Mortgage (3), Mosaic (1), Mosquito (2). 'Mora', 'Morp' and 'Mort' come in that order, then 'Mosa' before 'Mosq'.

Q.17 · Answer (B) 29

The second number is 7 times the first: 26 × 7 = 182 and 38 × 7 = 266. So 203 ÷ 7 = 29.

Q.18 · Answer (C) ÷ and –, 4 and 12

Interchanging ÷ and – and 4 and 12: 4 × 5 + 7 − 12 ÷ 6 = 20 + 7 − 2 = 25.

Q.21 · Answer (A) (11, 9, 396)

The third number is 4 times the product of the first two: 6 × 8 × 4 = 192. Likewise 11 × 9 × 4 = 396.

Q.23 · Answer (B) 250

Each term is twice the one before plus 1, 2, 3, ...: 14 × 2 + 1 = 29, 29 × 2 + 2 = 60, 60 × 2 + 3 = 123, 123 × 2 + 4 = 250, and 250 × 2 + 5 = 505.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Agriculture

A soldier works for security, as a farmer works in agriculture: a worker and the field of his work.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (B) Anjum Moudgil

Anjum Moudgil is an Indian rifle shooter, silver medallist in the 10 m air rifle at the 2018 World Championship. Aditi Chauhan and Ashalata Devi are footballers and Amit Panghal is a boxer.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Kshipra

Ujjain stands on the Kshipra (Shipra), a tributary of the Chambal, where the Simhastha Kumbh Mela is held.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Shaikh Nizamuddin Auliya Dargah - Agra

The dargah of Shaikh Nizamuddin Auliya is in Delhi, not Agra. Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki's is at Mehrauli, Delhi, Haji Ali's in Mumbai and Muinuddin Chishti's at Ajmer.

Q.4 · Answer (A) UNIX

UNIX, rewritten in C at Bell Labs in 1973, was the first operating system written in C.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Joint Photographic Experts Group

JPEG stands for Joint Photographic Experts Group, the committee that created the image standard.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Rani Rampal

Rani Rampal was captain of India's women's hockey team in 2020, the year she received the Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Nihal Sarin

Nihal Sarin won Chess.com's 2020 Junior Speed Chess Championship, beating Alexey Sarana 18-7 in the final.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Deepika Padukone
Deepika Padukone received the Crystal Award at the World Economic Forum in Davos in January 2020 for her work in raising awareness of mental health.

Q.9 · Answer (B) tax payers
Form 26AS is a taxpayer's annual tax statement: it shows the tax deducted or collected at source and the taxes paid against the PAN.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Eravikulam National Park
Eravikulam National Park, in Idukki district, Kerala, is home to the Nilgiri tahr. Tadoba and Sanjay Gandhi National Parks are in Maharashtra and Kaziranga is in Assam.

Q.11 · Answer (D) The normal systolic pressure is about 120 mm of Hg and diastolic pressure is 80 mm of Hg.
A healthy adult's blood pressure is about 120/80 mm of Hg: 120 systolic, as the heart contracts, and 80 diastolic, as it relaxes.

Q.12 · Answer (C) 13
There are 13 essential vitamins: A, C, D, E, K and the eight B vitamins.

Q.13 · Answer (D) Economic Sciences
Paul Milgrom and Robert Wilson won the 2020 prize in Economic Sciences for improvements to auction theory and new auction formats.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Goa
Goa had the highest per capita income (net state domestic product per head) of India's states in 2019-20, with Sikkim second; Gujarat and Kerala were well behind.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Russia
In the final of the 2020 Online Chess Olympiad two Indian players lost on time after their internet connections dropped; on India's appeal, FIDE declared India and Russia joint winners.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Atal Bihari Vajpayee
Good Governance Day, observed since 2014, marks the birth anniversary of former Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee on 25 December.

Q.17 · Answer (B) galaxy
IC 1101 is a giant galaxy at the centre of the Abell 2029 galaxy cluster, one of the largest galaxies known.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Calcutta
The Calcutta High Court, set up in 1862 under the Indian High Courts Act, 1861, is India's oldest; the Bombay and Madras High Courts followed later that year.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Speaker of the Lok Sabha
Under Section 12(3) of the RTI Act the Chief Information Commissioner is appointed on the recommendation of a committee of the Prime Minister (chair), the Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha and a Union Cabinet Minister nominated by the Prime Minister. The Speaker is not on it.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Tungabhadra
The Tungabhadra is a major tributary of the Krishna. The Bhavani, Hemavati and Amravati (Amaravathi) are tributaries of the Kaveri.

Q.21 · Answer (A) Rajasthan
Khyal is a traditional folk drama of Rajasthan, sung and danced, with regional styles such as the Kuchamani Khyal.

Q.22 · Answer (C) Forest kingdom
The 'atavika rajyas' were the forest kingdoms of central India; Samudragupta's Allahabad Pillar inscription records that he brought their rulers under his control.

Q.23 · Answer (A) Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs

The Directorate of Estates of the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs launched the e-Sampada web portal and mobile app on 25 December 2020, for services such as allotting government housing and booking holiday homes.

Q.25 · Answer (D) Jawa

Jawa is celebrated mainly by unmarried tribal girls of Jharkhand around the Karam festival: they tend baskets of germinating seeds and pray for fertility and a prosperous household.

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